

Apple open sources its Swift programming language

Much to the surprise of the gaming community, Apple has come up with Swift, a much simpler language that can be used for building applications for iPhones, iPads and the Mac. Many in the industry feel that Apple could be working on making this language run on other machines and servers loaded with Linux, on smartphones based on Google's Android mobile operating system, and on tablets based on Microsoft's operating system.

It will be run from the website called Swift.org and the code will be shared through GitHub. Swift is exclusively designed so that coders can not only build software capable of rapidly juggling myriad tasks at once, but do so quickly.

With this model of engagement, Apple can attract a bigger section of the broader community in different ways. Also, there is a demand for open source and this way, Swift's reach can be wider.

An open source Swift is Apple's way of embracing a sweeping trend in the world of computer software.

More and more, developers are using open source tools when building applications and online services, as are the tech industry's biggest corporations.



Canonical ties up with 6WIND

Canonical has joined hands with the high-performance networking software company 6WIND in a bid to step up the growth of Ubuntu cloud networking. The deal between Canonical and 6WIND will power the growth of cloud networking on the Ubuntu Linux operating system by putting together 6WIND's Virtual Accelerator software with Canonical's Juju service orchestration tool that lets users model, configure, deploy and manage cloud environments without any pain. 6WIND's Virtual Accelerator software includes exciting features like support for Open vSwitch, guest processing offloads, the Linux bridge, security, as well as multi-tenancy and filtering.



The addition of 6WIND's Virtual Accelerator software with Canonical's Juju service orchestration tool offers customers the option of creating cloud networks with high application throughput for various demanding scenarios like software-defined networking or network function virtualisation.

While Juju lets the Ubuntu community install OpenStack, hundreds of pre-configured services, or their own code to any private or public cloud, Virtual Accelerator deploys transparently in Linux kernel-based virtual machine hypervisor domains running on 32-bit (x86) servers to enhance the application throughput without using additional techniques.

KTU exams to run on open source software

The examinations conducted by Abdul Kalam Technological University (KTU), which run on an online platform, will switch to open source software from the second semester onwards, this academic year. For the first semester examinations, the university is using Microsoft software.

The hardware and software mechanisms of the examination system have been outsourced. This had come in for criticism from employees and students' groups, which accused the university of outsourcing the examinations to private firms. According to the university, only three companies in India have the software that is required for the examinations. The university floated tenders wherein these three companies took part, and the contract was awarded to the most competitive bidder.



Microsoft to open source Chakra JavaScript engine

Global tech giant Microsoft will open up its Chakra JavaScript engine as an open source project which will be available on GitHub in January 2016. According to a blog post, ChakraCore will comprise the key mechanism of the Chakra engine used for its Edge browser. The tech giant built its own JavaScript engine in 2008 like other vendors, as the coding language became increasingly crucial to the Web and for many other uses, including mobile apps, cloud services, NoSQL databases, game engines and front-end tools.

